Employee Handbook

Mitarbeiterhandbuch – Overview and Introduction

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Consulted	Thomas Bauer, Works Council Chair (Betriebsrat); Dr. Nadia Petrov, General Counsel and Data Protection Officer
Applies to	All employees of Norvane Systems GmbH at all sites (Munich, Berlin, Garching, Frankfurt), including working students, interns and apprentices
Classification	Internal
Language	English. A German version is available from HR on request.

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1 Welcome and purpose

1.1 Welcome

Welcome to Norvane Systems. Since 2011 we have grown from a small team into a company of about 600 people who run IT infrastructure, cloud platforms, cybersecurity and custom software for mid-size industrial customers. We are glad that you are part of the team.

1.2 What this handbook is

The Employee Handbook sets out our mission, our policies and our expectations. It explains your rights and responsibilities while you work for Norvane Systems, and it tells you where to find the detailed policy on each topic. Our mission is to run our customers' IT reliably and securely, and to treat each other with respect while doing so.

This document is the overview. It summarises the key rules of each topic and refers to the full policy where one exists. If this handbook and a specific policy differ, the specific policy applies, and HR will correct the handbook at the next revision.

1.3 How the handbook is organised

Part	Content	Full policy / owner
2 Employment basics	Contract types, equal opportunity, recruitment, attendance	HR (Jordan Ellis)
3 Workplace policies	Confidentiality, data protection, harassment, health and safety	NS-HR-POL-004; NS-LEG-POL-001; NS-EHS-PRC-001
4 Code of Conduct	Dress code, digital devices, conflicts of interest, relationships, relatives, visitors, solicitation	NS-HR-POL-001; NS-IT-POL-001
5 Compensation and development	Pay and payroll, performance management, training	HR (Julia Neumann)
6 Benefits and perks	Health, remote work, expenses, company vehicles, parking, equipment	HR; Facilities (Markus Vogel); IT (Jonas Keller)
7 Working hours and leave	Working time, vacation, holidays, sick leave, special leave, parental leave	NS-HR-POL-002
8 Leaving Norvane Systems	Discipline, resignation, termination, references	HR; Legal
9 Revisions and acknowledgement	Updates to this handbook and confirmation of receipt	HR

2 Employment basics

This section explains the basic terms of your employment. Use it as a first point of reference; your individual employment contract (Arbeitsvertrag) always takes precedence.

2.1 Employment contract types

Type	Description	Notes
Full-time	40 hours per week	Standard contract; probation 6 months
Part-time	Fewer than 40 hours per week, as agreed in the contract	Vacation and benefits are calculated pro rata where the law allows
Fixed-term (befristet)	Employment for a defined period or project	Reason or maximum term as required by law; stated in the contract
Working student (Werkstudent)	Student employed alongside university studies	Maximum weekly hours as agreed; usually in Engineering and IT Operations
Intern (Praktikant)	Internship of up to 6 months, mandatory or voluntary	Internship agreement; supervised by a named mentor
Apprentice (Auszubildende)	Dual vocational training in IT specialist roles	Training plan agreed with the vocational school and the Chamber of Commerce (IHK)

2.2 Equal opportunity

We recruit, develop and promote people on the basis of ability and performance. We do not tolerate discrimination on grounds of race or ethnic origin, gender, religion or belief, disability, age or sexual identity, in line with the General Equal Treatment Act (Allgemeines Gleichbehandlungsgesetz, AGG). This applies to every stage of employment, from job advertisements to termination. Our diversity is a strength, and it is also a precondition for a working culture of respect and meritocracy.

2.3 Recruitment and selection

Hiring managers follow the same process in all departments. Recruiting is coordinated by HR in Personio.

Step	What happens	Responsible
1 Requisition	Approved headcount and job profile are entered in Personio	Hiring manager, HR
2 Screening	CV review and a 30-minute phone interview	HR Generalist (Jordan Ellis)
3 Interviews	Two interviews, one technical or functional and one on team fit	Hiring manager, team members
4 Offer	Written offer after approval by the department head and HR	HR Director
5 Pre-employment checks	Only where legally justified for the role (for example a certificate of good conduct, Führungszeugnis, for roles with access to customer vaults); never ordered before the offer stage	HR with Legal
6 Contract and onboarding	Contract signed; onboarding plan issued at least 5 working days before the start date	HR, IT, line manager

Employee referral programme. If you refer a candidate who is hired, you receive a referral bonus of EUR 1,500, paid with the payroll after the new colleague has passed the 6-month probation. Referral bonuses are not paid for roles in HR or for your own line reports. Submit the referral through the Personio referral

link before the candidate applies.

2.4 Attendance

If you cannot come to work, inform your line manager and hr@norvane.example before 09:00 on the first day of absence (Garching shift staff: at least 30 minutes before the shift starts). Repeated or unexplained absence without notice may lead to a warning (Abmahnung). Details for illness are in section 7.4; planned absence is requested in Personio.

3 Workplace policies

This section describes the conditions in which we work. The binding rules are in NS-HR-POL-004 (Workplace Policies, version 2.1, effective 01.01.2026).

3.1 Confidentiality and data protection

You handle confidential information about Norvane Systems, our customers and our colleagues. Do not share it with anyone who has no business need to know, during and after your employment. We process personal data in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (Datenschutz-Grundverordnung, GDPR/DSGVO) and the Federal Data Protection Act (BDSG). This means:

- Collect and use personal data only for the purpose it was provided for.
- Store data only in approved systems (Microsoft 365, Confluence, ServiceNow, Personio); never in private cloud accounts or on private devices.
- Report a suspected data breach immediately to privacy@norvane.example and the helpdesk (ext. 3000), even outside office hours. Legal must notify the supervisory authority within 72 hours, so every hour counts.
- Direct questions from customers or data subjects about their data to the Data Protection Officer, Dr. Nadia Petrov.

See NS-LEG-POL-001 (Data Protection Policy) and NS-IT-POL-001 (Information Security Policy).

3.2 Harassment and violence

We are committed to a workplace free of harassment, bullying and violence. Harassment includes unwanted conduct that violates a person's dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile or humiliating environment, including sexual harassment, offensive messages and exclusion. Physical violence, threats and intimidation are never acceptable.

If you are affected or witness such behaviour, you may contact the Complaints Office (Beschwerdestelle) at HR (hr@norvane.example, ext. 2000), the Works Council (Betriebsrat), or the confidential ethics hotline (ethics@norvane.example, ext. 2650). Nobody will suffer a disadvantage for raising a concern in good faith. Substantiated cases lead to consequences up to and including termination, after a warning where the law requires it.

3.3 Health and safety

We comply with the Occupational Safety and Health Act (Arbeitsschutzgesetz, ArbSchG), the Occupational Safety Act (Arbeitssicherheitsgesetz, ASiG), the Workplace Ordinance (ArbStättV) and DGUV Vorschrift 1 of the statutory accident insurance. Our Safety Officer (Fachkraft für Arbeitssicherheit), Carlos Mendes, advises management and chairs the Workplace Safety Committee (Arbeitsschutzausschuss), which meets quarterly. Our company physician (Betriebsärztin), Dr. Sabine Lang, is on site at HQ on Tuesdays.

- **Prevention:** Risk assessments are carried out for every workplace type and reviewed at least annually. Garching warehouse staff receive safety shoes and instruction before they start work.
- **Emergencies:** Call 112 for fire and medical emergencies and 110 for police, then building security (ext. 9111, available 24/7). Follow NS-EHS-PRC-001 (Emergency and Evacuation Procedure).
- **Reporting:** Report accidents, near misses and hazards to your line manager and Carlos Mendes (ext. 2400) on the same day.

Site	Assembly point	Smoking area
Munich HQ	HQ courtyard, north side	HQ courtyard terrace
Berlin office	Front forecourt	Roof terrace
Garching depot	Parking area P2	Marked area outside Gate 2
Frankfurt data center	Gate A	No smoking on site

Smoking, alcohol and drugs. Smoking, including e-cigarettes, is allowed only in the marked areas above. Working under the influence of alcohol or drugs is not permitted. Alcohol may be served only at company events approved by the Managing Directors. The consumption of cannabis is not permitted on company premises or during working time, even though it is legal in private life under the Cannabis Act (KCanG). Prescribed medication that may affect your ability to work safely should be discussed with the company physician.

3.4 Mental health

Mental wellbeing is part of occupational health. Our Employee Assistance Programme (EAP) offers free and confidential counselling for you and your family. Contact Mariam Haddad, HR Business Partner and EAP Officer (eap@norvane.example, ext. 2010). Counselling sessions are not reported to your line manager.

4 Code of Conduct

Our Code of Conduct (NS-HR-POL-001) is the framework for how we treat colleagues, customers, partners and the public. It is about ethics and trust, and about a safe and professional space for everyone. The key points are summarised here.

4.1 Dress code

We have a smart-casual dress code at our offices. Wear business attire for customer meetings, unless the customer tells you otherwise. In the Garching depot and in data center areas you must wear the protective clothing and safety shoes required for the task. Clothing with offensive or political slogans is not appropriate at work.

4.2 Cyber security and digital devices

We trust you to use company devices responsibly, within the Information Security Policy (NS-IT-POL-001). Limited private use of company email and internet is tolerated if it does not interfere with work or security. Always use the VPN on public or hotel Wi-Fi, lock your screen when you leave your desk, and report lost devices to the helpdesk within 24 hours. When posting on social media, make clear that your views are your own, and never share customer names, internal documents or screenshots of internal systems without approval. Company mobile phones are issued by IT through ServiceNow for roles that need them.

4.3 Conflict of interest

A conflict of interest exists when a personal interest could influence, or appear to influence, your business decisions. Examples are a financial stake in a supplier or competitor, paid side jobs for customers, or awarding work to relatives. Declare any possible conflict in writing to your line manager and HR before acting on it. Secondary employment requires the prior written approval of HR. Knowingly breaking the law or company rules in this area may lead to a warning or termination, and Procurement (Ingrid Larsen) applies the four-eyes principle for supplier selection.

4.4 Relationships between employees

We respect private friendships and relationships between colleagues. Where one person has influence over the other's pay, assessment or career, inform HR so that the reporting line can be adjusted. Keep behaviour at work professional and keep private disputes out of team channels.

4.5 Employment of relatives

Relatives and partners may work for Norvane Systems. To avoid any suspicion of favouritism, they may not be in a direct reporting line, and may not approve each other's expenses, time records or payments. Disclose the relationship to HR before the contract is signed or as soon as it arises.

4.6 Workplace visitors

Visitors protect our property and our data only if everyone follows the same process. Register guests in advance with reception, collect a visitor badge at the entrance, and accompany them at all times. Visitors may not enter the data center, the Garching depot or the server rooms without approval from Priya Raman (CISO) or Anja Richter (COO). Report unaccompanied visitors to building security (ext. 9111).

4.7 Solicitation and distribution

Do not solicit colleagues or distribute flyers, products or services on company premises or through company systems for commercial or private purposes. Notices of the Works Council and approved company information are not affected. Report outsiders who try to sell or distribute items to reception or building security.

5 Compensation and development

This section explains how we pay and reward your work and how we support your development.

5.1 Pay and payroll

Salary is paid monthly, on the last working day of the month, into the bank account you registered in Personio. Payslips are available in Personio. Pay is processed by Finance in DATEV. Overtime must be agreed with your line manager in advance and is recorded in the flexitime account in Personio; for

employees with a time-recording obligation it is compensated by time off in lieu. Questions on payroll go to hr@norvane.example.

5.2 Performance management

Performance reviews help you to understand how your work is assessed and what you can improve. Our annual cycle has three stages:

Stage	Timing	Content
Goal setting	January	Line manager and employee agree 3 to 5 goals for the year
Mid-year check-in	July	Progress, feedback and adjustment of goals
Year-end review	December	Assessment of results and behaviours, development plan

Managers also hold regular one-to-one meetings, at least every 4 weeks, and are expected to give timely, fair and specific feedback.

5.3 Training and development

Each employee has an individual learning budget of EUR 1,500 per year for courses, certifications and conferences, which your line manager approves. Mandatory training (information security, data protection, workplace safety) is completed in the learning platform within 30 days of joining and then once a year. Time for approved training counts as working time.

6 Benefits and perks

Our benefits are summarised below so that you know what is available to you.

Benefit	What you get	Contact
Health	Occupational health care by the company physician, annual flu vaccination, EAP counselling, ergonomic workplace check, gym subsidy of EUR 25 per month	HR (Mariam Haddad)
Company pension	Employer-funded company pension scheme (betriebliche Altersversorgung) after probation	HR (Jordan Ellis)
Remote work	Hybrid working, 2 remote days per week	Line manager
Equipment	Laptop, headset and monitor; mobile phone for qualifying roles	Helpdesk, ext. 3000
Company vehicles	Pool and role-based vehicles in Garching and for field service	Facilities (Markus Vogel)
Parking	Limited parking spaces at HQ and Garching	Facilities (Markus Vogel)

6.1 Health, accident insurance and accidents at work

You are covered by statutory health insurance (Krankenkasse) of your choice, with the employer contribution paid by us. Accidents at work and on the direct commute are insured by the statutory accident insurance (Berufsgenossenschaft). If you have an accident at work, get medical help first, then inform your line manager and Carlos Mendes immediately. The company submits the accident report (Unfallanzeige) to the Berufsgenossenschaft where required, and we will help you with every step. Tell your doctor that the accident happened at work.

6.2 Work from home

We work hybrid: up to 2 remote days per week, agreed with your team. Additional remote days or permanent remote work require the written approval of your line manager and HR. Remote workers must use the company VPN, keep company data off private devices, and work from a place where screens and calls cannot be seen or heard by others. Working from outside Germany requires prior approval from HR and the CISO because of tax, social security and data protection issues, and is limited to 20 working days per calendar year.

6.3 Employee expenses

We reimburse reasonable business expenses with receipts, such as travel, accommodation and customer meals. Submit your claim within 30 days of the expense in Personio.

Amount per claim	Approval required
Up to EUR 500	Standard processing by Finance
Above EUR 500	Line manager
Above EUR 5,000	Director (department head)

6.4 Company vehicles

Company vehicles are used for business purposes only unless a written agreement says otherwise. Drivers need a valid licence, which Facilities checks twice a year. We pay fuel, charging and tolls for business trips. Traffic fines and parking tickets are the driver's responsibility. Report accidents and damage to Facilities and, where necessary, the police at once, and keep the vehicle clean and locked.

6.5 Parking

Parking spaces at HQ are limited. Facilities allocates them on the basis of need, in this order: mobility needs, shift work or late working hours with no public transport, and car-pooling. Spaces cannot be passed on to others. Garching staff can use the parking area P2 (also the assembly point; keep access routes free). Bicycle stands and showers are available at HQ and in Berlin.

6.6 Company-issued equipment

You are responsible for the equipment issued to you. Use it with care, protect it against loss, and return it when you leave. Report loss or theft to the helpdesk within 24 hours; in case of theft also to the police and building security. Employees are liable for loss or damage only if caused by intent or gross negligence, in line with the principles of German employment law.

7 Working hours and leave

The detailed rules are in NS-HR-POL-002 (Leave and Absence Policy). Absences are requested and approved in Personio.

7.1 Working hours

Group	Weekly hours	Working time model
Munich, Berlin, Frankfurt office staff	40 h	Flexitime with core hours 10:00-15:00; hybrid with 2 remote days per week
Garching early shift	40 h	06:00-14:30
Garching late shift	40 h	14:00-22:30

Breaks and rest periods follow the legal minimum of the Working Time Act (Arbeitszeitgesetz). Record your time in Personio.

7.2 Vacation

You are entitled to 30 days of vacation (Urlaub) per calendar year, for a five-day week, plus public holidays. Submit your request in Personio at least 2 weeks ahead for leave longer than 5 days. Please take at least 10 consecutive days once a year. Unused days must be taken by 31 March of the following year, in line with the Federal Vacation Act (BUrlG), unless your manager and HR have agreed otherwise because of illness or operational reasons.

7.3 Public holidays

We observe the public holidays of the federal state of your workplace: Bavarian holidays for Munich and Garching, Berlin holidays for the Berlin office and Hessian holidays for Frankfurt. If you must work on a public holiday, for example in on-call or data center operation, you receive time off in lieu or the supplement stated in your contract.

7.4 Sick leave

If you are unable to work because of illness, notify your line manager and HR by 09:00 on the first day (section 2.4). Provide a doctor's note from the third calendar day of illness; we may ask for it earlier if necessary. Your pay continues for up to 6 weeks, in accordance with the Continued Remuneration Act (Entgeltfortzahlungsgesetz, EFZG). After that, the statutory health insurance pays sickness benefit. After 6 weeks of absence within 12 months, HR will offer you a conversation about returning to work (betriebliches Eingliederungsmanagement), and you decide whether you want to take part.

7.5 Special leave

Occasion	Paid leave	Proof
Death of partner, child, parent or sibling (bereavement)	2 working days	Notification to line manager
Death of other close relatives	1 working day	Notification to line manager
Own wedding or registered partnership	1 working day	Marriage certificate
Moving house (employer-initiated)	1 working day	Notification
Court summons as a witness or lay judge, civic duty, voting	Time needed, if not possible outside working hours	Summons or notice

Please inform your line manager as early as possible. If you need more time after a loss, speak to HR in confidence, and the EAP is available to you.

7.6 Parental leave

Expectant mothers are protected by the Maternity Protection Act (Mutterschutz). Both parents are entitled to statutory parental leave (Elternzeit) after the birth or adoption of a child. Inform HR as early as possible, and in any case in good time before the planned start. HR will explain the application, the parental allowance (Elterngeld) procedure and your options for part-time work during Elternzeit. Employees are released for up to 4 hours for school or kindergarten events, such as enrolment and parent-teacher meetings, on agreement with their line manager.

8 Leaving Norvane Systems

If our working relationship ends, we want it to be fair and transparent for everyone. Employment can end through resignation, termination by the company or a mutual termination agreement (Aufhebungsvertrag). All notices of termination must be in writing (Schriftform).

8.1 Progressive discipline

Where conduct or performance does not meet the expectations of this handbook, we first discuss the issue with the employee and agree on how to improve. If the problem continues, the employee receives a formal written warning (Abmahnung) that describes the behaviour and the consequences of repetition. Termination for behavioural reasons normally follows only after a warning, except in very serious cases. Managers consult HR before every formal step. The Works Council is involved where required.

8.2 Resignation

Situation	Notice period
During probation (first 6 months)	2 weeks
After probation	3 months to the end of a calendar month

Submit your resignation in writing, signed, to HR (hr@norvane.example). Extended notice periods that apply by law or contract apply to both parties. We do not accept forced resignations, and nobody will be pressured to resign. If we paid for training or relocation with a repayment agreement, the terms in your signed agreement apply, and these are checked by HR in each case.

8.3 Termination by the company

Before any termination by the company, the Works Council (Betriebsrat) is heard in accordance with the Works Constitution Act (Betriebsverfassungsgesetz, BetrVG), and Legal checks the notice. We comply with all statutory protections, for example for pregnancy, severe disability and parental leave. There is generally no automatic entitlement to severance pay; where a severance payment is agreed, for example in a settlement, it is set out in a written agreement. Remaining vacation is taken before the last day or, if that is not possible, paid out under the Federal Vacation Act. Final pay, the return of equipment and the exit checklist are handled by HR, IT and Facilities.

8.4 References

Every employee is entitled to a written reference (Arbeitszeugnis) on leaving the company and to an interim reference during employment if there is a good reason. We issue a qualified reference on request, usually within 10 working days of the last working day. References are truthful and written in a benevolent style. Reference requests from future employers are answered only with your consent.

9 Revisions and acknowledgement

This handbook is reviewed once a year, and earlier when the law or our policies change. HR announces changes on the intranet (intranet.norvane.example) and by email. Substantive changes that require co-determination are agreed with the Works Council first. The current version is always the one on the intranet.

Please confirm that you have received and read this handbook. HR keeps the signed confirmation in your personnel file, and you will be asked again after material changes.

Name	
Employee ID	NS-10
Handbook version	1.2 (effective 01.01.2026)
Ort, Datum (Place, Date)	
Datum / Unterschrift (Date / Signature)	

We are very happy that you work with us. If you have any questions about anything in this handbook, please talk to your line manager or to HR. Welcome to the team.

10 Key contacts

Topic	Contact	Email	Ext.
HR general, absences, contracts	HR team	hr@norvane.example	2000
HR Director	Julia Neumann	julia.neumann@norvane.example	2001
EAP and mental health	Mariam Haddad	eap@norvane.example	2010
Payroll, recruiting, benefits	Jordan Ellis	jordan.ellis@norvane.example	2020
Safety Officer	Carlos Mendes	carlos.mendes@norvane.example	2400
Company physician (Tuesdays, HQ)	Dr. Sabine Lang	sabine.lang@norvane.example	2450
Works Council (Betriebsrat)	Thomas Bauer	betriebsrat@norvane.example	2500
Data protection, legal	Dr. Nadia Petrov	privacy@norvane.example	2600
Ethics hotline	Dr. Nadia Petrov	ethics@norvane.example	2650
IT helpdesk	Jonas Keller (IT Manager)	helpdesk@norvane.example	3000
Facilities, parking, vehicles	Markus Vogel	markus.vogel@norvane.example	6100
Building security (24/7)	Security	security@norvane.example	9111

Emergency: 112. Police: 110.

11 Related documents

Document ID	Title	Relevance
NS-HR-POL-001	Code of Conduct	Section 4
NS-HR-POL-002	Leave and Absence Policy	Sections 2.4 and 7
NS-HR-POL-004	Workplace Policies (v2.1, effective 01.01.2026)	Section 3
NS-IT-POL-001	Information Security Policy	Sections 3.1, 4.2, 6.2
NS-LEG-POL-001	Data Protection Policy	Section 3.1
NS-EHS-PRC-001	Emergency and Evacuation Procedure	Section 3.3

12 Version history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	15.03.2024	Julia Neumann	First issue of the Employee Handbook
1.1	01.02.2025	Jordan Ellis	Updated benefits, expense approval limits and contacts
1.2	01.01.2026	Julia Neumann	Aligned with NS-HR-POL-004 v2.1; added referral programme and special leave table

Norvane Systems GmbH · Parkring 12, 80339 München, Germany · Tel. +49 89 99998-100 · www.norvane.example
Amtsgericht München, HRB 287654 · VAT ID DE312874596 · Managing Directors (Geschäftsführer): Dr. Katharina Weber, Lukas Brandt